

Part 3 — Ad Creatives: Write-up

Three creative sizes, three different funnel roles — not the same message scaled up. Each size's information budget dictated a different job: the banner has to be read and clicked in well under a second, the square banner has room for exactly one real hook, and the full-screen format has enough space to show an actual quiz question and start the funnel a step early. All three share the same visual mark, the same design tokens as the live flow, and click through to the real entry point — never an invented landing experience the quiz itself doesn't deliver.

Creative 1 — Banner (320×50)

At this size there's room for roughly three or four words alongside the mark and CTA, so the copy carries only what actually moves a click: the value claim ("What's your IQ?") and the cost/time signal ("Free · 2 min"), with a real button for affordance even though the whole banner is one clickthrough. The time claim matches the entry screen's own "about 2 minutes" rather than promising something shorter — a banner that overpromises speed just moves the trust failure from first load to mid-quiz instead of removing it.

Creative 2 — Square Banner (250×250)

The first version of this creative led with an actual pattern-recognition question rendered as an icon grid. Built and reviewed, it didn't work: the specific pattern chosen had an answer visible at a glance, which closes the curiosity gap instead of opening it — the viewer already knows the answer before reading the CTA, so "Find out" promises something already delivered for free. Replaced with a self-insight headline ("What's your cognitive strength?") that mirrors the live flow's own partial-result framing — an answer that genuinely can't be known by looking at the ad. The subtitle states "IQ Test" explicitly, since this campaign runs on exact-match search keywords ("free iq test" / "iq test") and a headline built entirely around "cognitive strength" would otherwise lose message match with what the visitor just typed. "Free" moved from a small subtitle into the CTA itself ("Try Free") — it's the strongest objection-remover this size has, and it was under-selling itself as gray secondary text.

Creative 3 — Full-Screen Mobile (1080×1920)

This format has room to show a real quiz question with its answer options, so it doubles as a funnel head-start rather than just a larger ad. The single click-through target skips straight to Q1 of the live quiz instead of the entry screen — cutting a full step out of the funnel for traffic that arrives through this creative specifically. A served image ad has exactly one click-through URL for the whole image, so a per-answer deep link (tap "8", land already answered) isn't possible as the primary deliverable; that fuller mechanism exists as a bonus interactive HTML build alongside the required PNG, not in place of it. The featured question is a 3×3 arithmetic matrix (each row's third cell is the sum of the first two) rather than a simple count-up sequence — a genuine one-rule puzzle that rewards a second look, matched to a placement with enough attention-space to earn it. Copy is ordered deliberately: headline and a "Free" badge share one row, a short challenge line ("Most people miss this one") sits right before the puzzle to build desire before the payoff, and the CTA ("Start the quiz →") describes exactly what the tap does rather than implying an in-ad interaction that doesn't exist.

Shared building blocks

All three creatives are self-contained HTML files that read styles/tokens.css directly, so colors, radii, and type scale can never drift from the live product — and pull real question content from src/questions.js at runtime rather than retyping it, so what's teased is always what's actually asked post-click. The mark is the same SVG used on the live entry screen; no separate creative-only branding was introduced.

AI usage

Claude Code caught two rendering-pipeline defects mid-build that weren't visible from reading the code: the export renderer's CSS engine silently drops `var()` custom properties (resolved with an export-time token substitution pass, keeping the checked-in HTML on real, browser-correct `var()`), and an icon-sizing bug where each option's SVG canvas was cropped to its own shape count, so a single-shape option stretched to fill the same display size as a three-shape option and read as visually larger despite an identical absolute scale — fixed by computing one shared canvas size per question. Both are logged in AI_WORKFLOW.md.